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A Specification at a glance

The tables below show the units for GCE Business Studies at a glance. To gain an AS qualification in Business Studies, students must complete Unit 1 and Unit 2a. To gain an Advanced GCE qualification in Business Studies, students must complete Unit 1, Unit 2a, Unit 3 and Unit 4a.

GCE Business Studies

AS	Unit 1: Developing New Business Ideas	*Unit code 6BS01	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: January 2009		50% of the total AS marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: This unit covers the characteristics students would need to develop to be successful in business and how new or existing businesses generate their product or service ideas and test them through market research. Students should also consider the competition in the market; the economic climate; how the business might be financed and how much revenue the idea might generate. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 15 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: supported multiple-choice questions. ■ Section B: questions based on data.			

AS	Unit 2a: Managing the Business	*Unit code 6BS02	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: June 2009		50% of the total AS marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: This unit covers key activities which students may be involved in if they were to set up and/or manage a business whether small, medium-sized or large. It also introduces students to some basic management tools and models which will be developed in the A2 qualifications. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 15 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: supported multiple-choice questions. ■ Section B: questions based on data.			

A2 Unit 3: International Business		*Unit code 6BS03	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: January 2010		50% of the total A2 marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: The aim of this unit is to introduce the student to the world of international business and issues which a company trading internationally would have to consider. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 30 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: questions based on data. ■ Section B: case study and questions.			

A2 Unit 4a: Making Business Decisions		*Unit code 6BS04	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: January 2010		50% of the total A2 marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: In this unit, students will be able to assess the current competitiveness of a business through performance and non performance indicators. They will analyse corporate objectives and strategy on the basis of these indicators and on external influences to the business. Students will be required to assess the causes and effects of change on a business and examine how the company could manage risk effectively. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 30 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: questions based on data. ■ Section B: decision-making report and questions. (Context of decision-making report pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk in June of the previous year.)			

* See *Appendix 5* for description of this code and all other codes relevant to this qualification.

The tables below show the units for GCE Economics and Business at a glance. To gain an AS qualification in Economics and Business, students must complete Unit 1 and Unit 2b. To gain an Advanced GCE qualification in Economics and Business, students must complete Unit 1, Unit 2b, Unit 3 and Unit 4b.

GCE Economics and Business

AS	Unit 1: Developing New Business Ideas	*Unit code 6EB01	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: January 2009		50% of the total AS marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: This unit covers the characteristics students would need to develop to be successful in business and how new or existing businesses generate their product or service ideas and test them through market research. Students should also consider the competition in the market; the economic climate; how the business might be financed and how much revenue the idea might generate. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 15 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: supported multiple-choice questions. ■ Section B: questions based on data.			

AS	Unit 2b: Business Economics	*Unit code 6EB02	
■ Externally assessed ■ Availability: January and June ■ First assessment: June 2009		50% of the total AS marks	25% of the total GCE marks
Content summary: This unit considers the market that the business may be operating in; how competition in the market and macroeconomic change is likely to affect it and how businesses can seek to minimise uncertainty through their actions. Assessment: Examination of 1 hour 15 minutes in two sections. ■ Section A: supported multiple-choice questions. ■ Section B: questions based on data.			

A2 Unit 3: International Business***Unit code 6EB03**

- Externally assessed
- Availability: January and June
- First assessment: January 2010

**50%
of the
total A2
marks****25% of
the total
GCE
marks****Content summary:**

The aim of this unit is to introduce the student to the world of international business and issues which a company trading internationally would have to consider.

Assessment:

Examination of 1 hour 30 minutes in two sections.

Section A: questions based on data.

Section B: case study and questions.

A2 Unit 4b: The Wider Economic Environment and Business***Unit code 6EB04**

- Externally assessed
- Availability: January and June
- First assessment: January 2010

**50%
of the
total A2
marks****25% of
the total
GCE
marks****Content summary:**

In this unit, students consider why certain markets fail; how government decision making affects the economy and markets in which companies operate, and the income and welfare of private individuals. The unit should enable students to assess why government economic policy can succeed or fail and why regulation of some markets is necessary.

Assessment:

Examination of 1 hour 30 minutes in two sections.

Section A: questions based on data.

Section B: decision-making report and questions. (Context of decision-making report pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk in June of the previous year.)

B Specification overview

Summary of assessment requirements

**Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE Business Studies
– Units 1, 2a, 3, 4a**
**Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE Economics and
Business – Units 1, 2b, 3, 4b**

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Developing New Business Ideas	AS	Examination length: 1 hour 15 minutes Section A: supported multiple-choice questions where students write a short justification of why they chose that answer and/or why the other answers are incorrect. Worth 32 marks. Section B: questions based on 'data'. Worth 38 marks.	70 marks
Unit 2a: Managing the Business	AS	Examination length: 1 hour 15 minutes Section A: supported multiple-choice questions where students write a short justification of why they chose that answer and/or why the other answers are incorrect. Worth 24 marks. Section B: questions based on 'data'. Worth 46 marks.	70 marks
Unit 2b: Business Economics	AS	Examination length: 1 hour 15 minutes Section A: supported multiple-choice questions where students write a short justification of why they chose that answer and/or why the other answers are incorrect. Worth 24 marks. Section B: questions based on 'data'. Worth 46 marks.	70 marks
Unit 3: International Business	A2	Examination length: 1 hour 30 minutes Section A: questions based on 'data'. Worth 35 marks. Section B: case study and questions. Worth 45 marks.	80 marks
Unit 4a: Making Business Decisions	A2	Examination length: 1 hour 30 minutes Section A: questions based on 'data'. Worth 30 marks. Section B: decision-making report and questions. Worth 50 marks. Context of decision-making report pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk in June of the previous year.	80 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 4b: The Wider Economic Environment and Business	A2	Examination length: 1 hour 30 minutes Section A: questions based on 'data'. Worth 30 marks. Section B: decision-making report and questions. Worth 50 marks. Context of decision-making report pre-released on www.edexcel.org.uk in June of the previous year.	80 marks

Note: 'data' represents passages of text which may include graphs, table(s) of information or diagrams.

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
A01	Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified content.	30%	20%	25%
A02	Apply knowledge and understanding of the specified content to problems and issues arising from both familiar and unfamiliar situations.	30%	20%	25%
A03	Analyse problems, issues and situations.	20%	30%	25%
A04	Evaluate, distinguish between and assess appropriateness of fact and opinion, and judge information from a variety of sources.	20%	30%	25%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective				
	A01	A02	A03	A04	Total for A01, A02, A03 and A04
Unit 1	7.5%	7.5%	5%	5%	25%
Unit 2a/b	7.5%	7.5%	5%	5%	25%
Unit 3	5%	5%	7.5%	7.5%	25%
Unit 4a/b	5%	5%	7.5%	7.5%	25%
Total for Advanced GCE	25%	25%	25%	25%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. The Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE in Business Studies draw on the subject criteria for Business Studies, which are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies. The joint Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business Studies will cover approximately 50% of the subject criteria for Business Studies and approximately 50% of the subject criteria for Economics.

Aims

The Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business Studies specification aims to encourage students to:

- develop an interest in and enthusiasm for the study of business
- gain a holistic understanding of business
- develop a critical understanding of organisations and their ability to meet society's needs and wants
- understand that business behaviour can be studied from a range of perspectives
- generate enterprising and creative solutions to business problems and issues
- be aware of the ethical dilemmas and responsibilities faced by organisations and individuals
- acquire a range of relevant business and generic skills, including decision making, problem solving, the challenging of assumptions and the quantification and management of information.

The Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business specification aims to encourage students to:

- develop an interest in and enthusiasm for the study of economics
- appreciate the contribution of economics to the understanding of the wider economic and social environment
- develop an understanding of a range of economic concepts and an ability to use these economic concepts in a variety of different contexts
- use an enquiring, critical and thoughtful approach to the study of economics and an ability to think as an economist.

**AS/A2 knowledge
and understanding**

**This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business
Studies specification requires students to:**

- investigate different types of business organisations which could be set up to develop and sell a product or service idea in a local, national or international marketplace. At A2 level, students will study the ways in which companies grow bearing in mind the markets in which companies are operating
- be able to analyse numerical information to identify, for example, poor cash flow or labour productivity and the reasons for this
- promote a holistic understanding of business through considering how a new business idea is developed, understanding how a business is managed, how its performance is analysed and how it could trade overseas.

The Advanced GCE in Economics and Business specification requires students to:

- use case studies to develop an understanding of economic concepts and theories through a critical consideration of current economic issues, problems and institutions that affect everyday life
- analyse, explain and evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of the market economy and the effectiveness of government policy and action within it
- develop a critical approach to economic models and methods of enquiry.

AS/A2 skills

**The Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business
Studies specification requires students to:**

- use both qualitative and quantitative methods to make justifiable decisions, taking into account opportunity cost.

**The Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics
and Business specification requires students to:**

- select, interpret and use appropriate economic data from a range of sources.

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Unit 4b The Wider Economic Environment and Business	45
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Course structure

Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Business Studies

Edexcel's Advanced GCE in Business Studies comprises four units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of two AS units.

- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE in Business Studies is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Units 1 and 2a. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent of the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE in Business Studies award consists of the two AS units (Units 1 and 2a), plus two A2 units (Units 3 and 4a) which make up the other 50 per cent of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced GCE must, therefore, complete all four units.

Edexcel Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE in Economics and Business

Edexcel's Advanced GCE in Economics and Business comprises four units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of two AS units.

- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE in Economics and Business is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Unit 1 and 2b. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent of the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE in Economics and Business award consists of the two AS units (Unit 1 and Unit 2b), plus two A2 units (Unit 3 and Unit 4b) which make up the other 50 per cent of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced GCE must, therefore, complete all four units.